

head on a pedestal. It was going to immortalize the founder of their good fortune, Francesco Sforza (1401–1466). He would be shown sitting astride a horse. The statue would be cast in bronze, stand about 16 ft (5 m) tall, and weigh around 20,000 lb (9,000 kg).

Leonardo worked steadily on the sculpture, but several years passed before he finally finished a clay model of the horse. The next step would have been to begin the casting, but the timing was unlucky. In 1499, the French invaded Milan and war broke out. The bronze earmarked for the statue was made into cannons instead.

One of Leonardo's other projects was making a silver stringed instrument in the shape of a horse's skull. This work was funded by Lorenzo de Medici.

Leonardo took it with him to Milan and played it for Ludovico when his patron became the Duke of Milan in 1494. The instrument's large size and unique design gave it a rich sound, and Leonardo was able to play it with great skill.